

WEEK 3

Print Edition

Week 3 Study Guide

Stomach & Spleen Channels

ST (45 pts) + SP (21 pts) = 66 Points

This Document Contains:

- Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming (ST1-ST45) with MOA + CAM figures
- ST 6 Branches - full detailed running course
- ST 11 Crossing Points - the most of any channel
- Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin (SP1-SP21) with MOA + CAM figures
- SP Distribution Exception - the 8-cun crossover rule
- SP 6 Crossing Points - abdomen and chest
- Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls - direct from lecture
- Quiz 3 fundamentals: distribution, circuits, nomenclature
- ST vs SP Quick Reference - side-by-side comparison

QUIZ 3 (next class) covers: ST & SP channels

HT & SI will be TAUGHT next week (Week 4).

MOA: ST pp.125-176 | SP pp.177-207 | CAM: Col. Fig. 3-5

Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming (ST)

Yang | Earth | 7-9 AM | 45 Points

Pertaining Stomach

Connecting Spleen

Back-Shu BL21

Front-Mu CV12 Zhongwan

Yuan-Source ST42

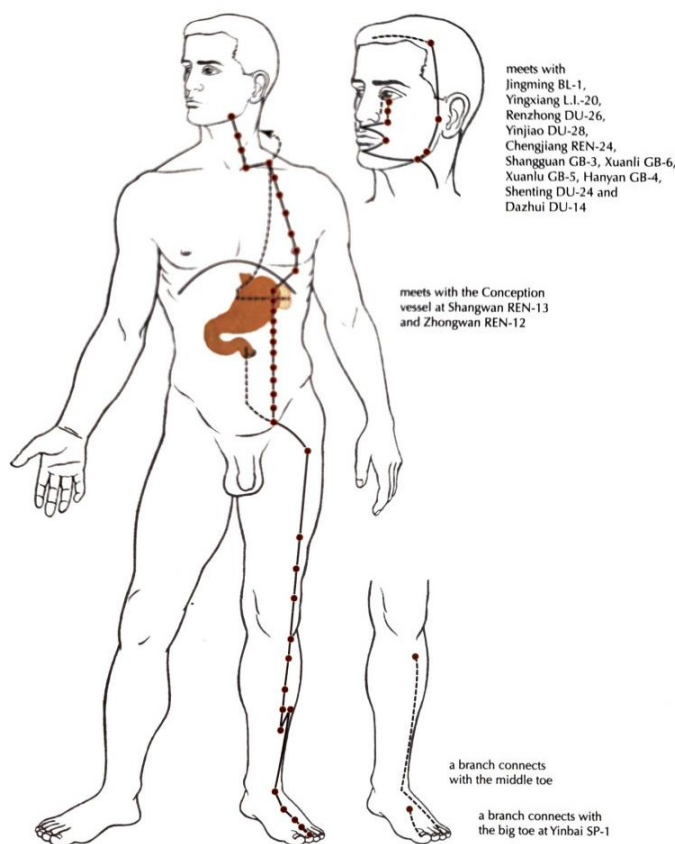
Luo ST40

He-Sea ST36

Internal Running Course

Stomach Channel

THE STOMACH CHANNEL OF FOOT YANGMING



MOA - Stomach Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts from lateral side of ala nasi (Yingxiang, LI20) - ST begins at LI20 crossing point
- 2 Ascends to bridge of nose, meets BL1 (Jingming) - Bladder crossing point
- 3 Turns down lateral nose (Chengqi, ST1), enters UPPER GUM - note: upper gum = ST, lower gum = LI
- 4 Curves around lips, descends to CV24 (Chengjiang) at mentolabial groove
- 5 Runs posterolaterally across cheek (ST5 Daying), winds along mandible angle (ST6 Jiache), ascends in front of ear via GB3, follows hairline (GB4, GB6) to forehead
- 6 FACIAL BRANCH: from ST5 -> neck (ST9 Renying) -> throat (ST10-11) -> supraclavicular fossa (ST12) -> through diaphragm -> PERTAINS STOMACH, connects SPLEEN
- 7 STRAIGHT PORTION: from supraclavicular fossa, passes through NIPPLE (UNIQUE TO ST ONLY), descends beside umbilicus (ST19-ST29), enters lateral lower abdomen at Qichong (ST30)
- 8 BRANCH FROM STOMACH LOWER ORIFICE: descends inside abdomen -> joins ST30 -> anterior thigh (ST31-32) -> knee -> anterior border of lateral tibia -> dorsum of foot -> lateral tip of 2nd toe (ST45 Lidui)
- 9 TIBIAL BRANCH: from ST36 (3 cun below knee) -> lateral side of middle toe
- 10 FOOT BRANCH: from ST42 (dorsum of foot) -> medial tip of great toe (SP1 Yinbai) -> links SPLEEN MERIDIAN

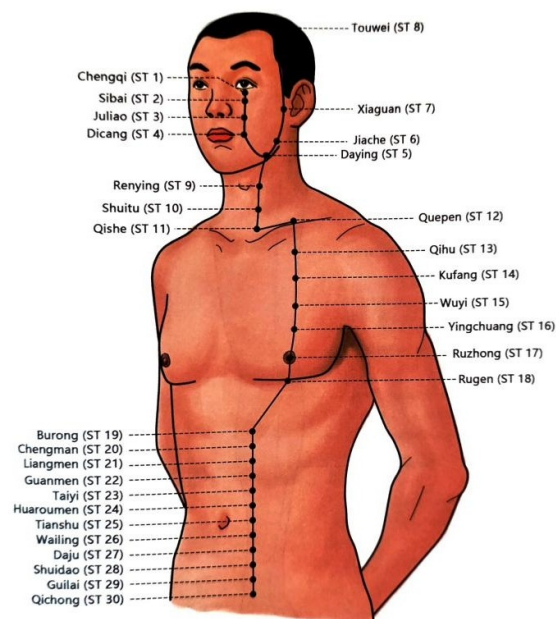
Functions (MOA)

- Governs reception & transformation of food/grain (Sea of Grain)
- Descends Stomach Qi (paired with SP ascending function)
- Dominates muscles and flesh; controls descent
- ONLY channel passing through the NIPPLE (exam-critical)
- Front-Mu: CV12 Zhongwan | Back-Shu: BL21 Weishu

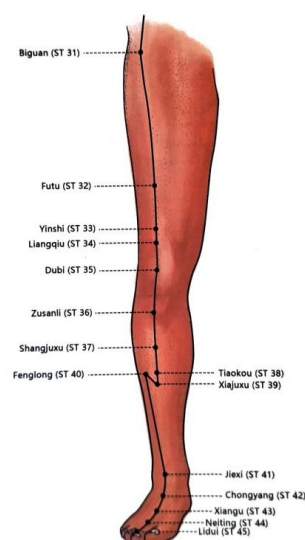
Stomach Meridian (ST) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

Pertaining	Stomach	Connecting	Spleen	Back-Shu	BL21	Front-Mu	CV12	Yuan-Source	ST42	Luo	ST40	He-Sea	ST36	Command	ST36
Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes													
ST1	Chengqi	Below pupil, between eyeball & infraorbital ridge													
ST2	Sibai	1 cun below ST1, in infraorbital foramen													
ST3	Juliao	Directly below ST2, level with ala nasi													
ST4	Dicang	Lateral to corner of mouth - LI crossing point													
ST5	Daying	Anterior angle of mandible, where facial pulse is palpable													
ST6	Jiache	1 finger-breadth up & forward from angle of jaw													
ST7	Xiaguan	Below zygomatic arch, anterior to condyloid process													
ST8	Touwei	0.5 cun within anterior hairline, 4.5 cun lateral to midline													
ST9	Renying	Level with Adam's apple, on carotid artery - WINDOW OF HEAVEN													
ST10	Shuitu	Between SCM muscle & thyroid cartilage													
ST11	Qishe	Above medial end of clavicle													
ST12	Quepen	Center of supraclavicular fossa, 4 cun from midline													
ST13	Qihu	Below midpoint of clavicle, 4 cun lateral to midline													
ST14	Kufang	1st intercostal space, 4 cun lateral to midline													
ST15	Wuyi	2nd intercostal space, 4 cun lateral to midline													
ST16	Yingchuang	3rd intercostal space, 4 cun lateral to midline													
ST17	Ruzhong	CENTER OF NIPPLE - landmark reference only, NOT needed													
ST18	Rugen	Below breast, 5th intercostal space, 4 cun lateral													
ST19	Burong	6 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST20	Chengman	5 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST21	Liangmen	4 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST22	Guanmen	3 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST23	Taiyi	2 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST24	Huaroumen	1 cun above navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST25	Tianshu	Level with navel, 2 cun lateral - FRONT-MU of LARGE INTESTINE													
ST26	Wailing	1 cun below navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST27	Daju	2 cun below navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST28	Shuidao	3 cun below navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST29	Guilai	4 cun below navel, 2 cun lateral to midline													
ST30	Qichong	5 cun below navel, 2 cun lateral - Chong Mai origin													
ST31	Biguan	Directly below ASIS, level with perineum													
ST32	Futu	6 cun above superolateral border of patella													
ST33	Yinshi	3 cun above superolateral border of patella													
ST34	Liangqiu	2 cun above superolateral border of patella - XI-CLEFT													
ST35	Dubi	Depression lateral to patellar ligament, knee eye													
ST36	Zusanli	3 cun below ST35, 1 finger-breadth lateral to tibial crest													
ST37	Shangjuxu	6 cun below ST35 - LOWER HE-SEA of Large Intestine													
ST38	Tiaokou	8 cun below ST35, 1 finger-breadth lateral to tibial crest													
ST39	Xiajuxu	9 cun below ST35 - LOWER HE-SEA of Small Intestine													
ST40	Fenglong	8 cun above ST41, 2 finger-breadths lateral to tibia - LUO													
ST41	Jiexi	Center of dorsal ankle crease, between tendons - JING-RIVER													
ST42	Chongyang	Dorsum of foot, highest point - YUAN-SOURCE													
ST43	Xiangqu	Between 2nd/3rd metatarsals, proximal to MTP joint - SHU-STREAM													
ST44	Neiting	Between 2nd/3rd toes, proximal to web margin - YING-SPRING													
ST45	Lidui	Lateral nail corner of 2nd toe - JING-WELL													

Col. Fig. 3 The Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming (I)



Col. Fig. 4 The Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming (II)



CAM Col. Fig. 3 (upper) | Col. Fig. 4 (leg) - Stomach Meridian

ST - The 11 Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: "ST has 11 crossing points - the most of any single channel. Most are located in the face.
Any facial symptom: paralysis, eye problems, mouth/lip problems - ALWAYS consider ST channel first."

LI20 Yingxiang - ST begins here

LI20 / LI channel

Location: Nasolabial groove, lateral to nostril - where LI ends and ST begins

Clinical: ST originates at a crossing point of the LI channel. Treats nasal congestion, loss of smell, facial paralysis. LI20 is where the anterior circuit hand-yang transitions to foot-yang.

BL1 Jingming - Bridge of nose

BL1 / BL channel

Location: Inner canthus of eye, 0.1 cun above medial canthus

Clinical: ST meets BL here. Treats all eye disorders: redness, pain, myopia, night blindness. Point where ST turns from ascending to descending.

GB3 Shangguan - In front of ear

GB3 / GB channel

Location: In front of ear, above condyloid process of mandible

Clinical: ST traverses this GB point as it ascends past the ear toward the forehead. Used for ear and temporomandibular joint disorders.

GB4 Hanyan - Anterior hairline (temporal)

GB4 / GB channel

Location: Within anterior hairline, 0.5 cun posterior to ST8

Clinical: ST follows hairline crossing GB4. Relevant for migraine, temporal headache, tinnitus.

GB6 Xuanli - Anterior hairline (mid-temporal)

GB6 / GB channel

Location: Within anterior hairline, between GB4 and GB7

Clinical: Second GB crossing along the hairline. Migraine on vertex/temporal region, pain along hairline, eye pain.

SP1 Yinbai - Great toe (foot branch)

SP1 / SP channel

Location: Medial nail corner of big toe - also the FIRST point of SP

Clinical: The FOOT BRANCH of ST ends at SP1, linking the ST and SP channels. This is where the anterior circuit continues from yang (ST) to yin (SP). Dr.

Zhang: 'This is how ST and SP are connected externally - not just internally.'

GV24 Shenting - Forehead

GV24 / Du Mai

Location: On the midline, 0.5 cun within the anterior hairline

Clinical: ST meets the Governor Vessel at the forehead/hairline. Used for headache, dizziness, anxiety, nasal disorders.

GV26 Shuigou - Philtrum

GV26 / Du Mai

Location: Upper third of philtrum, between nose and upper lip

Clinical: ST branch curves around lips and crosses the Du Mai here. Emergency resuscitation point. Also where the LI channel crosses (LI also crosses GV26). Facial paralysis, mouth deviation, LOC.

CV12 Zhongwan - Middle abdomen

CV12 / Ren Mai

Location: On midline, 4 cun above navel - FRONT-MU of Stomach

Clinical: ST's internal branch reaches CV12, its own Front-Mu point. Master point for all digestive/stomach disorders. Nausea, vomiting, gastritis, epigastric pain, bloating.

CV13 Shangwan - Upper abdomen

CV13 / Ren Mai

Location: On midline, 5 cun above navel

Clinical: Above CV12. Epigastric pain, vomiting, regurgitation. ST internal course passes through this region connecting stomach and spleen.

CV24 Chengjiang - Mentolabial groove

CV24 / Ren Mai

Location: In the center of the mentolabial groove (chin-lip groove)

Clinical: ST curves around lips and descends to meet the Ren Mai here before running posterolaterally across the cheek to ST5. Facial paralysis, mouth deviation, drooling, toothache.

ST - Syndromes & High-Yield Points

A. External Course Symptoms

- High fever, tidal fevers, flushed face
- Sweating; pain in the eyes
- Fever blisters (mouth/lips), sore throat
- Swelling of neck, facial paralysis
- Chest pain; pain/coldness along leg/foot
- UPPER teeth and gums (ST channel)

B. Internal Organ (Stomach)

- Abdominal distension, fullness, edema
- Persistent hunger (stomach fire)
- Nausea, vomiting, belching, hiccup
- Diarrhea, dysentery
- Digestive weakness (Qi deficiency)
- Nipple pain or numbness (ONLY ST!)

UPPER teeth/gums = ST (ST enters UPPER gum) | LOWER teeth/gums = LI (LI enters LOWER gum)

Dr. Zhang: "Please remember this - it is highly likely to appear on Quiz 3."

High-Yield ST Points

Pt	Chinese	Category	Key Indications
ST1	<i>Chengqi</i>	Jing-Well region	Eye disorders: conjunctivitis, night blindness, myopia; facial paralysis
ST4	<i>Dicang</i>	Crossing (LI+ST)	Facial paralysis, mouth deviation, drooling; treats both LI and ST simultaneously
ST9	<i>Renying</i>	Window of Heaven	Goiter, scrofula; regulates Blood Pressure; carotid region - CAUTION needling
ST25	<i>Tianshu</i>	Front-Mu of LI	Key GI pt: diarrhea, constipation, borborygmus; regulates LI & intestines
ST34	<i>Liangqiu</i>	Xi-Cleft	ACUTE stomach pain, gastritis, knee pain; urgency and painful conditions only
ST36	<i>Zusanli</i>	He-Sea + Command + Abdomen	#1 tonic: tonifies Qi & Blood, boosts immunity; digestion; Nature studies: anti-inflammation
ST37	<i>Shangjuxu</i>	Lower He-Sea of LI	LI disorders: diarrhea, dysentery, abdominal pain; appendicitis
ST39	<i>Xiajuxu</i>	Lower He-Sea of SI	SI disorders; diarrhea, lower abdominal pain
ST40	<i>Fenglong</i>	Luo-Connecting	#1 phlegm point in TCM: resolves phlegm-dampness ANYWHERE; cough, nausea, mental clouding
ST44	<i>Neiting</i>	Ying-Spring	Clears Yangming heat: toothache (UPPER), epistaxis, fever, sore throat
ST45	<i>Lidui</i>	Jing-Well	Nightmares, insomnia, manic behavior, facial swelling; LAST point

Five-Shu (Antique) Points - ST | Yang channel: Jing-Well = Metal

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Metal	ST45 Lidui	Nightmares, facial swelling, insomnia, manic behavior
Ying-Spring	Water	ST44 Neiting	Clears heat: toothache (UPPER), fever, epistaxis, sore throat
Shu-Stream	Wood	ST43 Xiangyu	Edema, fullness, eye pain, fever with heavy sensation
Jing-River	Fire	ST41 Jiexi	Ankle/foot disorders, facial puffiness, epilepsy
He-Sea	Earth	ST36 Zusanli	Master tonic; abdomen command; immunity; anti-inflammation (Nature)

Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin (SP)

Yin | Earth | 9-11 AM | 21 Points

Pertaining Spleen

Connecting Stomach

Back-Shu BL20

Front-Mu LRI3 Zhangmen

Yuan-Source SP3

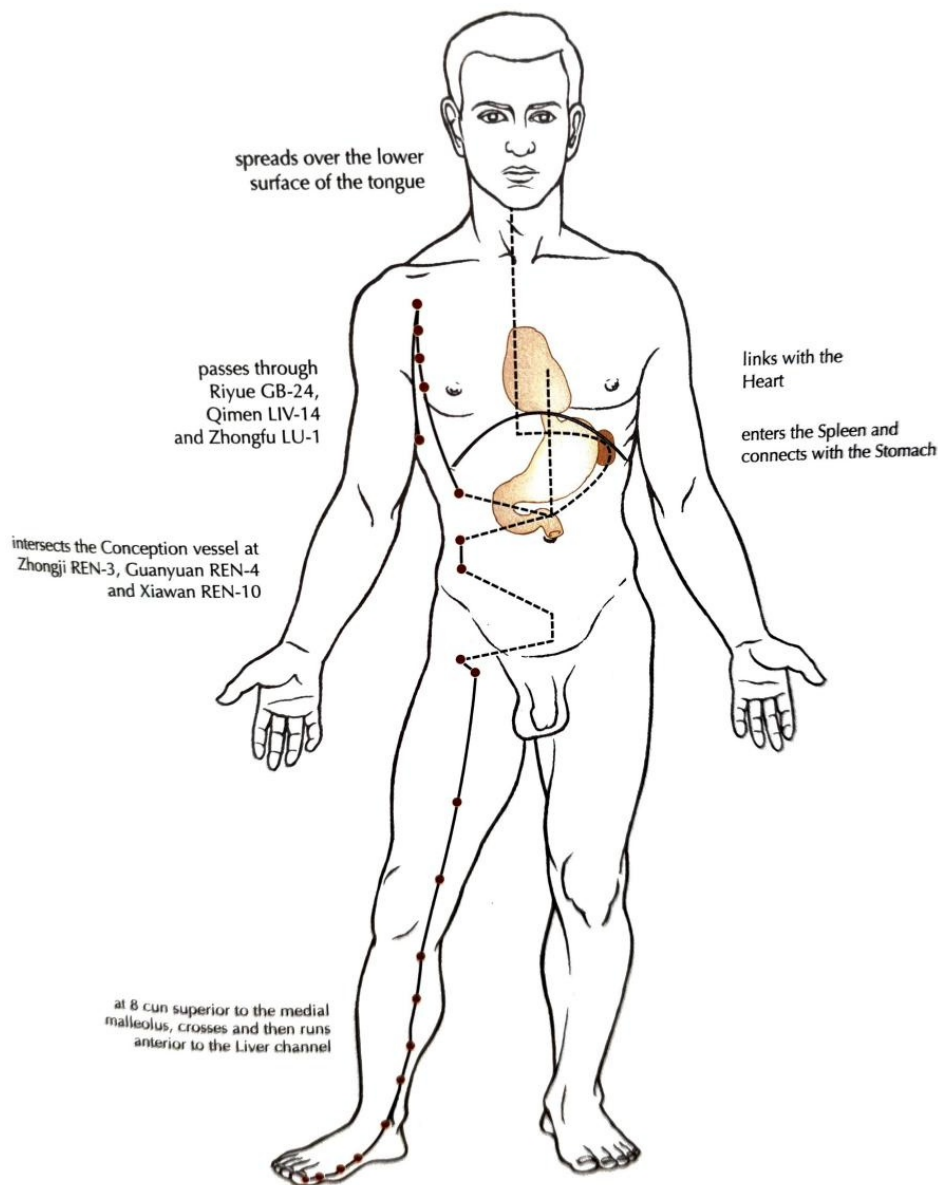
Luo SP4

He-Sea SP9

Xi-Cleft SP8

Internal Running Course

THE SPLEEN CHANNEL OF FOOT TAIYIN



MOA - Spleen Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts at medial tip of big toe - SP1 (Yinbai), Jing-Well point
- 2 Runs along medial aspect of foot at junction of red and white skin
- 3 Ascends in front of medial malleolus (SP5 Shangqiu area)
- 4 Up medial aspect of leg, follows POSTERIOR border of tibia
- 5 EXCEPTION at 8 cun above medial malleolus: SP CROSSES IN FRONT of LR meridian - the only exception to the three-yin distribution rule in all 12 meridians
- 6 Passes through anterior-medial aspect of knee and thigh
- 7 Enters abdomen (SP12-SP16, CV3, CV4, CV10) - PERTAINS SPLEEN, connects STOMACH
- 8 Passes through DIAPHRAGM, runs alongside ESOPHAGUS
- 9 Reaches root of tongue - SPREADS OVER LOWER SURFACE OF TONGUE (unique to SP only)
- Br BRANCH: from stomach through diaphragm -> flows into HEART -> connects Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin (HT) - this is what links anterior circuit to fire circuit

Functions (MOA)

- Governs transformation & transportation (Yun Hua) - digestion
- Controls Blood - keeps blood in vessels (deficiency = bleeding)
- Dominates the muscles and four limbs
- Opens into mouth; manifests in the lips
- ONLY meridian spreading over LOWER SURFACE OF TONGUE
- SP ascending / ST descending - postnatal Qi dynamic pair

DISTRIBUTION EXCEPTION (Exam-Critical):

Below 8 cun above medial malleolus: SP runs POSTERIOR to LR | Above 8 cun: SP CROSSES IN FRONT of LR

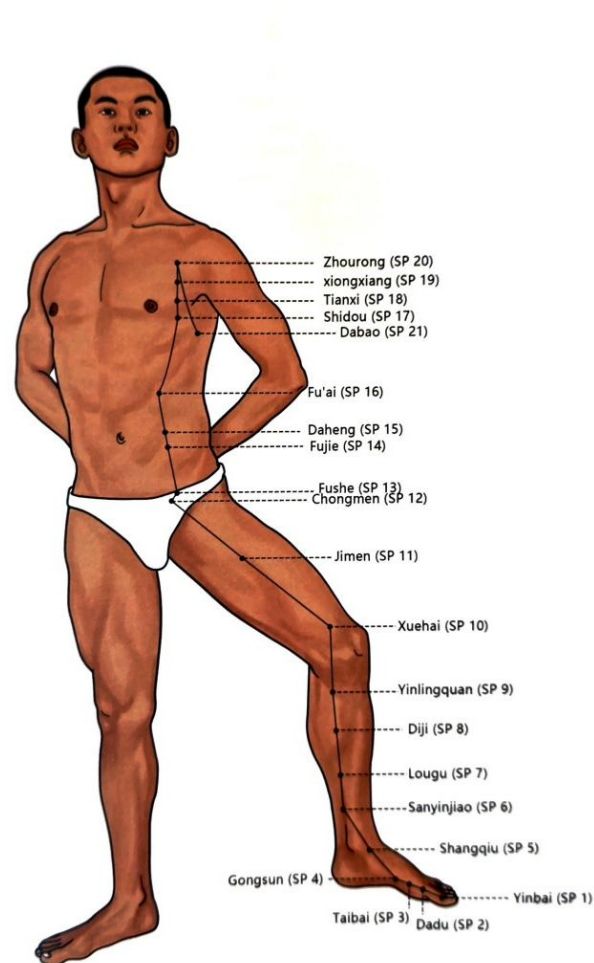
Dr. Zhang: "This is the ONLY exception of the distribution pattern in all 12 meridians."

Spleen Meridian (SP) - External Running Course & CAM Figure

Pertaining *Spleen* | Connecting *Stomach* | Back-Shu *BL20* | Front-Mu *LRI3* | Yuan-Source *SP3* | Luo *SP4* | He-Sea *SP9* | Xi-Cleft *SP8* | Clock 9-11 AM

Pt	Chinese	Location & Notes
SP1	<i>Yinbai</i>	Medial nail corner of big toe - JING-WELL
SP2	<i>Dadu</i>	Distal to 1st MTP joint, red/white skin junction - YING-SPRING
SP3	<i>Taibai</i>	Proximal to 1st MTP joint, red/white junction - SHU-STREAM / YUAN
SP4	<i>Gongsun</i>	1 cun proximal to SP3, base of 1st metatarsal - LUO / CONFLUENT
SP5	<i>Shangqiu</i>	Anterior-inferior to medial malleolus - JING-RIVER
SP6	<i>Sanyinjiao</i>	3 cun above medial malleolus, posterior tibial border - 3-YIN CROSSING
SP7	<i>Lougu</i>	6 cun above medial malleolus, posterior border of tibia
SP8	<i>Diji</i>	3 cun below SP9, posterior tibial border - XI-CLEFT
SP9	<i>Yinlingquan</i>	Depression below medial condyle of tibia - HE-SEA
SP10	<i>Xuehai</i>	2 cun above medial border of patella - SEA OF BLOOD
SP11	<i>Jimen</i>	6 cun above SP10, on medial aspect of thigh
SP12	<i>Chongmen</i>	3.5 cun lateral to midline, at the inguinal groove
SP13	<i>Fushe</i>	0.7 cun above SP12, 4 cun lateral to midline
SP14	<i>Fujie</i>	1.3 cun below SP15, 4 cun lateral to midline
SP15	<i>Daheng</i>	Level with navel, 4 cun lateral to midline
SP16	<i>Fuai</i>	3 cun above SP15, 4 cun lateral to midline
SP17	<i>Shidou</i>	5th intercostal space, 6 cun lateral to midline
SP18	<i>Tianxi</i>	4th intercostal space, 6 cun lateral to midline
SP19	<i>Xiongxiang</i>	3rd intercostal space, 6 cun lateral to midline
SP20	<i>Zhourong</i>	2nd intercostal space, 6 cun lateral to midline
SP21	<i>Dabao</i>	Midaxillary line, 6th intercostal space - GREAT LUO of SP

Col. Fig. 5 The Spleen Meridian of Foot Taiyin



CAM Col. Fig. 5 - Spleen Meridian of Foot Taiyin

SP – Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: "SP has 6 crossing points – most located in the abdomen and chest (CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1). This explains why SP points are so powerful for abdominal, chest, and organ-level conditions."

CV3 Zhongji – Lower abdomen

CV3 / Ren Mai – Front-Mu of BL

Location: On midline, 4 cun below navel – Front-Mu of Bladder

Clinical: SP crosses CV3 entering the lower abdomen. Treats urinary retention, menstrual disorders, uterine prolapse, genital pain. Combining SP and CV3 simultaneously treats SP and BL conditions.

CV4 Guanyuan – Gate of Origin

CV4 / Ren Mai – Front-Mu of SI

Location: On midline, 3 cun below navel – Front-Mu of Small Intestine; major Qi gate

Clinical: Vital Qi gate – one of the most important tonification points. SP channel passes through here on its way into the abdomen. Menstrual regulation, infertility, impotence, chronic deficiency.

CV10 Xiawan – Lower stomach region

CV10 / Ren Mai

Location: On midline, 2 cun above navel

Clinical: SP intersects Ren Mai at CV10 as it connects with the Stomach. Treats indigestion, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal fullness – useful when both SP and Stomach are involved.

GB24 Riyue – Lateral chest

GB24 / GB channel – Front-Mu of GB

Location: Anterior chest, 7th intercostal space, 4 cun lateral to midline – Front-Mu of Gallbladder

Clinical: SP meets the GB channel laterally in the chest. One needle at GB24 treats SP, LR, and GB simultaneously. Hypochondriac pain, jaundice, acid regurgitation.

LR14 Qimen – Lateral chest

LR14 / LR channel – Front-Mu of LR

Location: Directly below nipple, 6th intercostal space – Front-Mu of Liver

Clinical: SP intersects LR at its Front-Mu point. SP, LR, and ST all connected at this level. Hypochondriac fullness/pain, vomiting, diarrhea, breast disorders. Critical for liver-spleen disharmony patterns.

LU1 Zhongfu – Chest / shoulder

LU1 / LU channel – Front-Mu of LU

Location: Below clavicle, 6 cun lateral to midline, 1st intercostal space – Front-Mu of Lung

Clinical: SP's branch goes up through the diaphragm and connects here at LU1 before entering the heart. This is why SP channel pathology can present with chest and lung symptoms. Cough, asthma, chest fullness, shoulder pain.

A. External Course Symptoms

- Heaviness of body or head
- Fatigued limbs, emaciated muscles
- Stiffness of tongue, speech difficulty
- Coldness medial leg and knee
- Edema in foot or leg
- Numbness along SP channel

B. Internal Organ (Spleen)

- Abdominal pain, distension, diarrhea
- Poor digestion, vomiting
- Reduced appetite, constipation
- Hard lumps in abdomen
- Bleeding disorders (Blood not held)
- Irregular menstruation

High-Yield SP Points

Pt	Chinese	Category	Key Indications
SP1	Yinbai	Jing-Well	Uterine bleeding, menorrhagia, nightmares; calms Shen; channel start
SP3	Taibai	Shu-Stream + Yuan	Tonifies SP Qi; heaviness, fatigue, digestive weakness
SP4	Gongsun	Luo + Confluent (Chong Mai)	Opens Chong Mai; GI disorders, menstrual issues, chest/heart pain
SP6	Sanyinjiao	3-Yin Crossing	Gynaecology, menstruation; calms mind; SP/LR/KI - FORBIDDEN PREGNANCY
SP8	Diji	Xi-Cleft	ACUTE SP: acute abdominal pain, dysmenorrhea, irregular menstruation
SP9	Yinlingquan	He-Sea	#1 dampness point: edema, diarrhea, knee pain, urinary disorders
SP10	Xuehai	Sea of Blood	Cools/moves blood; urticaria, eczema, irregular menstruation, amenorrhea
SP21	Dabao	Great Luo of SP	Pain throughout body; weak limbs; major SP collateral - LAST POINT

Five-Shu (Antique) Points – SP | Yin channel: Jing-Well = Wood

Shu Point	Element	Pt	Clinical Use
Jing-Well	Wood	SP1 Yinbai	Uterine bleeding, nightmares, calms Shen
Ying-Spring	Fire	SP2 Dadu	Febrile disease without sweating, digestive heat
Shu-Stream	Earth	SP3 Taibai	Yuan-source; tonifies SP Qi; heaviness, fatigue
Jing-River	Metal	SP5 Shangqiu	Indigestion, borborygmus, ankle disorders
He-Sea	Water	SP9 Yinlingquan	Master dampness point; edema, urinary, diarrhea, knee

FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY: SP6 (Sanyinjiao) – 3-Yin Meeting point

Also: LI4, BL60, BL67. SP6 has strong descending/moving action on the uterus.

Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls - Direct from Lecture

Highest exam probability

ST is the 2nd Largest Meridian (45 pts, only BL has more)

The running course has SIX branches. Dr. Zhang played the pathway video 4 times and had students draw every branch. Know all 6: (1) face/forehead, (2) facial branch internal to ST+SP, (3) straight portion through the nipple to groin, (4) stomach orifice branch to 2nd toe, (5) tibial branch from ST36 to middle toe, (6) foot branch from ST42 to SP1.

Only ST Passes Through the NIPPLE

Dr. Zhang: 'Only stomach meridian passing through the nipple. If patients tell you pain in nipple, numbness in nipple - choose stomach meridian acupoints.' This is the single most distinguishing anatomical landmark of the ST channel. Exam will test this.

ST36 Zusanli - Anti-Inflammation (Published in Nature)

Dr. Zhang: 'Many studies published in Nature show ST36 can relieve inflammation immediately. It stimulates Qi and blood immediately.' ST36 = He-Sea + Command for Abdomen = most important tonic point in all of TCM. Location: 3 cun below ST35, 1 finger-breadth lateral to anterior crest of tibia.

ST40 Fenglong - #1 Phlegm Point in All of TCM

ST40 is the master phlegm-resolving point. Resolves phlegm-dampness ANYWHERE in the body - lungs, head (mental clouding and depression), chest, vessels. Luo-connecting point of ST. 8 cun above ST41, 2 finger-breadths lateral to the tibia.

SP Distribution Exception - 8 Cun Crossover

Dr. Zhang: 'This is the only exception of the distribution pattern rules in meridians. Only here the Taiyin is located in the middle (posterior position) - it exchanges the pattern and goes anterior.' Below 8 cun: SP is POSTERIOR to LR. Above 8 cun: SP CROSSES IN FRONT of LR. If the exam asks about the three-yin distribution exception - the answer is always SP.

Only SP Spreads Over the LOWER SURFACE of the TONGUE

Dr. Zhang: 'Numbness or stiffness in the lower surface of the tongue is always SP meridian in clinic. We choose spleen meridian acupoints to treat this.' No other of the 12 primary meridians spreads over the lower tongue surface. SP is the only one that distributes to the tongue root and lower surface.

SP & ST Pairing - Interior-Exterior Both Ways

Dr. Zhang: 'Any digestive problems - we can choose stomach meridians. We can also choose the spleen because the stomach and the spleen are paired.' ST descends, SP ascends - when this dynamic is disrupted: counter-flow ST Qi = vomiting; SP Qi not ascending = diarrhea. The treatment logic works in both directions for all paired channels.

Anterior Circuit Complete: LU -> LI -> ST -> SP

After Week 3, the entire Anterior Circuit is covered. Dr. Zhang: 'From chest to hand, hand to head, head to foot, foot to chest.' LU (chest->hand, medial anterior) -> LI (hand->head, lateral anterior) -> ST (head->foot, anterior lateral) -> SP (foot->chest, anterior medial). This is the Taiyin-Yangming axis of the anterior circuit.

Upper vs Lower Teeth - Know Both Meridians

UPPER teeth/gums = ST channel (ST enters UPPER gum, branch curves around lips). LOWER teeth/gums = LI channel (LI branch passes through LOWER gums). ST44 Neiting clears Yangming heat for upper toothache. LI4 Hegu for lower/neural toothache. Dr. Zhang tested this in Week 2 and will test the ST side in Week 3.

Quiz 3 Fundamentals – Distribution, Circuits & Nomenclature

From Dr. Zhang's review slides

Distribution of the 12 Main Meridians (slide 40)

ON THE LIMBS:

Medial aspect: YIN meridians

Lateral aspect: YANG meridians

Anterior: Taiyin (yin) / Yangming (yang)

Middle: Jueyin (yin) / Shaoyang (yang)

Posterior: Shaoyin (yin) / Taiyang (yang)

ON THE HEAD & TRUNK:

Anterior: Yangming Lateral: Shaoyang

Posterior: Taiyang

ST = Yangming = most lateral on trunk

Circulation of the 12 Meridians (slide 41)

- a) Yin meridians of HAND: chest -> hand
- b) Yang meridians of HAND: hand -> head
- c) Yang meridians of FOOT: head -> foot
- d) Yin meridians of FOOT: foot -> chest

Qi flows one direction only -

Dr. Zhang: "it never goes back."

This week completes the ANTERIOR circuit: LU -> LI -> ST -> SP

Circuit Connections – EXACTLY what links to what (exam trap)

LU (Lung) -> connects to LI at LU7 branch -> radial index finger (LI1)

LI (Large Intestine) -> connects to ST, NOT spleen -> ends lateral nose (ST begins LI20)

ST (Stomach) -> connects to SP at foot branch -> medial great toe (SP1)

SP (Spleen) -> connects to HT (Heart), NOT LI -> via internal branch to heart

Dr. Zhang stressed: LI connects to STOMACH (not spleen). SP connects to HEART (not LI).

Nomenclature

Meridian Name = 3 parts (slide 39)

1. Hand or Foot

2. Yin or Yang (Taiyin/Shaoyin/Jueyin, Yangming/Taiyang/Shaoyang)

3. Zang or Fu organ

e.g. "Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming"

Meridian Clock – ST & SP peak times

ST (Stomach): 7-9 AM – eat breakfast!

SP (Spleen): 9-11 AM

Preceded by: LI 5-7 AM | Followed by: HT 11-1 PM

Full order: LU LI ST SP HT SI BL KI PC SJ GB LR

24-hr cycle, 2 hrs each, Qi flows in sequence

Dr. Zhang's homework rule: DRAW BOTH internal AND external pathways for every meridian.

"Some students only draw external – the internal pathway is also important."

ST vs SP - Quick Reference Comparison

Attribute	ST Stomach (Foot Yangming)	SP Spleen (Foot Taiyin)
Yin / Yang	Yang (anterolateral)	Yin (anteromedial)
Element	Earth	Earth
Circuit	Anterior - Head to Foot	Anterior - Foot to Chest
Clock	7-9 AM	9-11 AM
Points	45 (ST1-ST45)	21 (SP1-SP21)
Start	ST1 Chengqi (beside nose)	SP1 Yinbai (medial big toe)
End	ST45 Lidui (lateral 2nd toe)	SP21 Dabao (lateral chest)
Branch	6 branches total	From stomach -> Heart (HT)
Pertaining	Stomach	Spleen
Connecting	Spleen	Stomach
Back-Shu	BL21	BL20
Front-Mu	CV12 Zhongwan	LR13 Zhangmen
Yuan-Source	ST42 Chongyang	SP3 Taibai
Luo	ST40 Fenglong	SP4 Gongsun
Xi-Cleft	ST34 Liangqiu	SP8 Diji
He-Sea	ST36 Zusanli	SP9 Yinlingquan
Confluent Pt	-	SP4 (opens Chong Mai)
Command Pt	ST36 (Abdomen)	-
Sea of Blood	-	SP10 Xuehai
Lower He-Sea	ST37 (LI) / ST39 (SI)	-
Forbidden Preg.	-	SP6 (HIGH PRIORITY)
Crossing Pts	11 (mostly face/head)	6 (mostly abdomen/chest)
Unique Feature	ONLY channel through NIPPLE	ONLY channel on lower TONGUE surface
Ext Symptoms	Fever, face/eye/mouth, chest, leg	Heaviness, fatigue, tongue, edema
Int Symptoms	Hunger, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea	Abd pain, poor digestion, bleeding
Organ Function	Governs reception & transformation	Transforms/transport; controls Blood
Qi Direction	Descends (ST Qi)	Ascends (SP Qi lifts)
Toothache	UPPER teeth (ST enters upper gum)	- (LI for LOWER teeth)